

Edmar Barros

Staff Backend Engineer

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Backend Engineer with 10+ years building and operating production-grade distributed systems, now a Founding Engineer building AI-driven growth tooling. I tie engineering work to business outcomes: opened a self-serve revenue stream with Stripe subscriptions, cut cloud spend by 41% a year, halved new-engineer ramp-up time, and reduced customer onboarding from 2 weeks to 1 day. Specialized in backend architecture (monolith-to-microservices), cloud infrastructure (GCP, AWS, Terraform, Kubernetes), CI/CD and data platforms (PostgreSQL, Kafka, Elasticsearch, BigQuery).

"The mind that opens to a new idea never returns to its original size." - Albert Einstein

Experience

Vocational

May 2026 - **Senior Software Engineer**, *Quander*, Remote.

Oct 2026 Maker of Hypesonic(<https://hypesonic.com/>), an AI growth platform that runs marketing and distribution continuously: testing creative, targeting audiences and optimizing ad spend without human bottlenecks.

Achievements:

- **Opened self-serve revenue:** Built the full subscription and payment flow on Stripe, letting customers sign up and pay on their own. Before this, B2B customers were billed manually.
- **Launched a new ad channel:** Delivered the full TikTok Ads integration end-to-end, giving customers a second paid channel alongside Meta.
- **Publish straight from the platform:** Built the Meta Ad Publisher so users create and manage Campaigns, Ad Sets and Ads and publish generated creatives without leaving the product.
- **More reliable ad data, smarter agents:** Reduced Meta Ad Sync error rates, closed data gaps and improved sync ETA estimates. Added agent tools that read Meta performance data, giving the AI agent richer context for decisions.
- **Restored domain trust:** Got hypesonic.com cleared from security vendor blocklists (Trellix, Palo Alto, SURBL, FortiGuard). Visitors had been hitting a risk warning page and emails were being flagged, which hurt traffic and signups.
- **Product insight & observability:** Added PostHog session recording and feature flags, plus Grafana metrics and dashboards, to inform product decisions and enable safe rollouts.
- **Content pipeline:** Built a curation mechanism that fills the ads library from external ad sources, and the first version of a video editor that applies templates to videos.

Key Technologies: NodeJS, Typescript, PostgreSQL, Docker, Vercel, Railways, LLM APIs & AI agents, Stripe, Meta Marketing API, TikTok Ads API, PostHog, Grafana

May 2024 - **Staff Backend Engineer**, *Vendoo*, Remote.

May 2026 Multichannel e-commerce platform processing 90k+ daily listings across distributed services.

Achievements:

- **Cut infrastructure spend by 41% a year:** Rebuilt an unbalanced Elasticsearch cluster (oversized shards, outdated version, no index lifecycle policies), and documented a roadmap for further savings.
- **Scaled to 90k+ daily listings:** Led the migration from a Node.js monolith to event-driven microservices on Kafka, reducing listing latency by 300ms, cutting failed marketplace syncs and speeding up new marketplace integrations.
- **Halved new-engineer ramp-up (6 to 3 weeks):** Launched internal Tech Talks (10+ sessions) and a structured 1:1 mentorship framework to close system knowledge gaps.
- **Faster, lighter releases:** Re-engineered build and deployment pipelines (GitHub Actions, CircleCI), shrinking Docker images by 70% (1GB to 300MB) and shortening deployment cycles.
- **Infrastructure ownership:** Owned GCP/Kubernetes infrastructure via Terraform and Helm (cluster provisioning, service mesh, environment promotion) and built the observability stack that caught performance bottlenecks before they reached users.

Key Technologies: NodeJS, Typescript, Kafka, PostgreSQL, GCP, BigQuery, Elasticsearch, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, CircleCI, Github Actions

- Jun. 2023 - **Senior Backend Engineer & Tech Lead**, *Vendoo*, Remote.
Apr. 2024 Multichannel Listing Tool and Inventory Management Software for Online Sellers.
- Achievements:**
- **Found the cause of low signup rates:** Led the investigation and found that referral campaigns sent users straight to a signup page with no information about Vendoo or its features. The growth team's A/B test confirmed that users landing on a custom page converted at a higher rate.
 - **Fixed subscription billing integrity:** Found and fixed a bug that kept 1% of paying users marked as active after they had cancelled, restoring accurate subscription and revenue data.
 - **Led a team of up to 5 engineers:** Designed, built and shipped backend services end-to-end, aligning technical decisions with product and business goals.
 - **Stable, predictable releases:** Owned release cycles and CI/CD (CircleCI), enforcing test coverage gates and automated deployments.
 - **Technical Design:** Drove data model and API design decisions, set coding standards and unblocked engineers on complex backend work.
 - **Stakeholder Coordination:** Worked with product and business stakeholders to scope sprints, define acceptance criteria and align engineering effort with company strategy.
- Jul. 2022 - **Senior Backend Engineer**, *Paerpay*, Remote.
May 2023 Mobile payment integration platform for the restaurant industry.
- Achievements:**
- **Cut partner support tickets by 30%+:** Built a real-time transaction monitoring pipeline on BigQuery, giving partners instant visibility into payment statuses.
 - **Onboarded national restaurant chains:** Designed adapters for multiple SOAP-based POS systems and REST payment gateways, unlocking integration with major national chains.
 - **Sub-second payments at peak:** Scaled backend services on Firebase and GCP to handle high-throughput payment processing during peak hours.
- Key Technologies: NodeJS, Typescript, Firebase, GCP, BigQuery, Docker
- Sep. 2021 - **Senior Backend Engineer & Architect**, *EMB Software Engineering*, Remote.
Apr. 2022 Software consultancy delivering cloud-native backends for data-heavy applications.
- Achievements:**
- **Repeatable client infrastructure:** Owned end-to-end AWS deployment with Terraform (VPCs, ECS clusters, RDS, CDN), reused across multiple client projects.
 - **Shorter delivery cycles:** Led API-First technical design, defining data models and interface contracts up front so teams could build in parallel and integrate with less friction.
 - **Technical Leadership:** Managed the full backend lifecycle from specification to production, mentoring engineers and removing blockers across sprints.
- Key Technologies: Python (Django), NodeJS, AWS, Terraform, Docker, Redis, PostgreSQL
- Jan. 2019 - **Senior Backend Engineer**, *Citruslabs*, Remote.
Sep. 2021 Clinical trial recruitment platform connecting patients to research.
- Achievements:**
- **Cut customer onboarding from 2 weeks to 1 day (93%):** Redesigned the MySQL data model so new trials and customers were set up through configuration instead of custom development.
 - **Lowered patient recruitment cost:** Built automated funnel tracking pipelines (1,000+ responses per trial) that exposed a 10% drop-off, which drove funnel changes that reduced recruitment cost.
 - **70% faster time-to-market:** Designed and implemented CI/CD workflows with GitHub Actions on AWS, increasing deployment frequency.
- Key Technologies: Python, NodeJS, MySQL, AWS, Docker, Github Actions

Education

- 2013– **MSc in Software Engineering**, *Coimbra University*, Coimbra.
Attended
- 2009–2014 **BSc in Computer Science**, *Coimbra University*, Coimbra.

Languages

Portuguese **Native**

English **Professional proficiency**

Used in daily work communication.

Spanish & **Basic proficiency**

French

Able to understand common phrases in professional settings.

Technical skills

Programming Python (Django, FastAPI), JavaScript/Typescript (NodeJS, React), Java, PHP, C

Cloud & Data GCP, AWS, BigQuery, Kafka, Elasticsearch, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform

Databases PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Firestore

CI/CD Github Actions, CircleCI, Jenkins

Social Skills

Communication Bridging the gap between complex backend architecture and business metrics.

Leadership Led and mentored engineering teams, fostering high-scale engineering cultures.

Additional Activities and Interests

IoT problem solver and Arduino enthusiast; home brewing enthusiast.